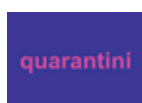




Lockdown Google-ing

Check out this article to see what was Googled the most in India during the lockdown. <https://digit.in/jun20-28>



Common Covid slang

Here is dictionary.com's list of slang terms that originated and were popularised during the pandemic. <https://digit.in/jun20-29>

HOT OR NOT

of a bad situation, and at the same time making sure that their children have some good memories to cherish in the future. We really like this new hobby, and hope that these boomers continue to farm the antics of their children for internet karma even after the lockdown lifts.



Credit: @bigbenmoore on Twitter

British journalist Ben Moore hosting a fancy dinner party for his children



QUIZZES: This is something that has taken over WhatsApp groups, as people began to rediscover the

simple joy of quizzing. The minimal Bollywood posters with symbolic representations for movies suddenly found themselves as fodder for questions. There was a scramble by quiz masters to come up with questions that could not be googled. As in all quizzes, the biggest part of the fun was in speed, which meant that people had to spend some time getting to know their home networks and optimising their connections. Protip: the fastest approach typically is to just use the mobile network, and not the wifi. It also meant that the settings in WhatsApp had to be changed, people had to pin groups temporarily, turn on automatic media download, and turn off autocorrect, which proved to be problematic for any quiz with local answers. Devious quizmasters of course asked responders to spell out difficult words in the middle of the quizzes! If only people

would move to Telegram, which has a quiz function by default, and a more advanced version available through quizbot as well. Both the Bihar and Odisha government put up quizzes to keep the population engaged through the lockdown. We always liked a quiz, even before the lockdown, both participating in them and coming up with the questions.



MASKNE: Hopefully most of you have been staying at home. However, those who have had essential jobs or worked in the media industry have been going outdoors, and these people know the actual problems with wearing masks for long periods of time. For one, if the respirators are being used, then it becomes increasingly difficult to breathe as the day goes on. Even the reusable mask get itchy after a while, and the heat of the harsh Indian summer does not help at all with a buildup of sweat within the mask. The masks can cause rashes or red marks after hours of use, and some people have experienced the worst of the afflictions related to the masks - maskne, or acne caused by wearing masks for extended periods of time.



CURATOR-BATTLE: The Yorkshire Museum challenged curators around the world to tweet the creepiest things from their collections, and these exhibits should never be shown to anyone, ever. Even the descriptions of some of the entries on the list are too impolite to be published, let alone the photos. The ones that we can write about are pincushions with baby heads, a blackened and dried up sheep's heart stuck with a bunch of nails, and an animal sculpture made from the severed lower leg of a human being. We are publishing what is perhaps

the picture from the contest that is the easiest on the eyes, but that may be because nobody has any idea what it is. According to the Nova Scotia Museum, the item is simply labelled "something in a jar".



NEW VOCABULARY: We find ourselves running out of space for all the notes we took over the previous month, so here is a quick and dirty guide to the new words that spring up. Zoom is now a verb, just like Google or Photoshop. Getting Zumped is being dumped on a Zoom call. A person who is mentally and physically exhausted after spending hours on back to back Zoom calls turns into a Zoombie. A fauxcation or a fakecation is a challenge that requires you to move nowhere, but pretend that you have gone on vacation. Send out the mails, set up the autoreply, change your status on



Credit: Nova Scotia Museum

Not even the winner of the battle

apps, then pretend that you are on a vacation while having gone absolutely nowhere. Those who are finding themselves burning through their savings in either comfort or panic buying are calling it the spendemic. Quarantaking is the idea of making breads at home when it is no longer possible to get a daily supply, or discovering the craft of making cakes and other pastries, because the time is available. A ghost game is a sporting event without any of the fans in attendance. A maskhole is someone who defies the guidelines implemented during the lockdown. 🔴